

Sloppy Joes

Serves: 4 | Prep: 10 min | Cook: 20 min

INGREDIENTS

- 500g lean ground beef (85–90% lean)
- 1 small onion, finely diced
- 1/2 green bell pepper, finely diced
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tbsp tomato paste
- 1/2 cup ketchup
- 1/3 cup water
- 1 tbsp brown sugar
- 1 tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- 2 tsp yellow mustard
- Salt, pepper & red pepper flakes to taste
- 4 hamburger buns, toasted

METHOD

Step 1

Heat olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Add onion and bell pepper; cook 3–4 minutes until softened. Add garlic and cook 30 seconds until fragrant.

Step 2

Add ground beef, breaking it up with a spoon. Cook for 5–7 minutes until browned through. Drain any excess fat.

Step 3

Stir in tomato paste and cook for 1 minute. Add ketchup, water, brown sugar, Worcestershire, mustard, salt, pepper and chilli flakes. Stir well.

Step 4

Reduce heat to medium and simmer for 10–12 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the sauce thickens to your liking.

Step 5

Pile generously onto toasted buns and serve.

TIPS & NOTES

- ◆ *This sauce freezes beautifully — make a double batch and freeze half for busy nights.*
- ◆ *Too sweet? Add a splash of apple cider vinegar. Too tangy? A little more brown sugar balances it.*
- ◆ *Also delicious served over waffle fries with melted cheese on top!*

